

Slides 01.16: Unit Price and Comparison Shopping

Lesson 1.16, one day, 13 slides. All prices marked *[update from this week's circular]*.

Slide 1: Do now

- A 16 oz box of pasta costs \$1.29.
- A 12 oz box of a different brand costs \$1.49.
- Which is the better buy? Show your thinking. Notes: Most pick \$1.29 because the number is smaller. Ask: smaller because it is a better deal, or because there is less in the box? Here it is both. The next one is harder.

Slide 2: Now this one

- 24 oz jar of sauce: \$2.29
- 45 oz jar of the same sauce: \$3.79
- The big one costs more. Is it the better buy?
- You cannot tell by looking. Image: the two jars side by side with the prices.

Slide 3: The rule

- Unit price = price divided by quantity
- $\$2.29 \text{ divided by } 24 \text{ oz} = \0.095 per oz
- $\$3.79 \text{ divided by } 45 \text{ oz} = \0.084 per oz
- The 45 oz jar wins per ounce.
- Write the dollar sign on every answer. No dollar sign means you divided the wrong way.

Slide 4: The store already did the math

- The shelf tag prints the unit price in small letters.
- The sale price is in big letters.
- Guess which one the store wants you to read. Image: a photo of a real supermarket shelf tag with the unit price circled.

Slide 5: Units have to match

- 1 pound = 16 ounces
- $\$4.99 \text{ for a } 2 \text{ lb bag} = \$4.99 \text{ for } 32 \text{ oz} = \0.156 per oz
- Never compare a per-pound price to a per-ounce price. Convert first.

Slide 6: Store brand vs name brand

- Often made in the same factory with a different label.
- Usually 20 to 40 percent less.
- Thumb up if you think the store brand wins per ounce. Image: a store-brand and a name-brand box of the same pasta. Notes: Reveal with the real packages and the math.

Slide 7: Small vs bulk

- Bulk usually wins per ounce.
- Bulk only wins if you can use it before it spoils and have a place to keep it.
- Thumb up for the big bag. Image: an 8 oz bag and a 2 lb bag of shredded cheese.

Slide 8: Sales tax at the register

- In New York, most grocery food is not taxed.
- Foil, paper plates, cups, soap: taxed.
- Candy, soda, prepared hot food: taxed.
- Our county: about 8.625 percent. *[Sal: confirm the local rate]*
- A \$3.49 roll of foil rings up at \$3.79.

Slide 9: Practice

- Part A: six unit prices. Part B: three better buys. Part D: the bulk trap.
- Pairs. Calculators. 12 minutes.
- Convert pounds to ounces before you compare.
- Peer checkers: help, do not tell.

Slide 10: The bulk trap

- 10 lb of potatoes for \$5.99. 3 lb for \$2.99.
- This family eats potatoes twice a month, 2 lb each time, and keeps them in a warm cabinet.
- Which bag? Notes: Take answers. Build the list on the next slide from what they say.

Slide 11: When cheaper is not better

- It will spoil before you use it.
- There is no room to store it.
- The family will not eat that much.
- A food rule or allergy rules it out.
- You cannot afford the bigger total today, even though it is cheaper per ounce. Notes: The last one is the hardest and the most real. Say it plainly.

Slide 12: Exit card

- 3 steps to find a unit price
- 2 reasons the cheaper unit price can be the wrong buy
- 1 item your family buys where you now want to check the shelf tag

Slide 13: Tomorrow

- You bought it. You got it home. Where does it go?
- Bring back the answer to: what temperature should a refrigerator be? Image: an open refrigerator, shelves empty.